

Chapter 169-1

Liang Shi never expected that Xu Qingzhu was a sister-complex.¹

But thinking back carefully, there had indeed been signs of this before.

Whether it was toward Xu Qingya or Sheng Yu, she was quite doting.

It was just that she appeared cold on the surface, so it wasn't obvious.

Looking deeper into it, Xu Qingzhu was the type of person who protected her own.

No matter what, she would protect her family first.

Liang Shi silently lit a candle for Zhou Yi'an in her heart.

She had been watching Zhou Yi'an and Su Meiqi's interactions from inside earlier, and always felt there was something indescribable between them.

With Zhou Yi'an's personality, she wouldn't be this patient with someone she wasn't interested in.

"Do you still hate Zhou Yi'an?" Liang Shi teased while opening the car door for her. "Teacher Xu holds grudges."

"I don't hold grudges." Xu Qingzhu got in the car. "If I have a grudge, I usually settle it on the spot."

Liang Shi: "..."

"She was pretty terrible at first." Xu Qingzhu said, "I really disliked her. But thinking about it later, I also played a trick on her."

Liang Shi remembered that time—she and Xu Qingzhu had played that trick together.

"Later, when I found out she was RT's Designer of the Year, it got a bit better." Xu Qingzhu's voice was still cold, but since she was talking to Liang Shi, it was much gentler. "Maybe it's a talent filter. Now that we've worked together for so long, I quite admire her work style."

Liang Shi understood.

She admired her work style but didn't like her as a person.

"What if Meiqi really does like her?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu paused. "Then let her like her."

She turned her face to look at Liang Shi's profile. It happened to be a red light, and the car stopped. Liang Shi also turned to look at her.

Their eyes met.

Xu Qingzhu smiled lightly, the corners of her lips curving up slightly, light dancing in her eyes. "She's an adult now. She has her own judgment."

A moment later, the car started again and merged into traffic.

Xu Qingzhu's voice was languid and casual. She drew out her words when calling Liang Shi's name: "Teacher Liang~"

"Hmm?"

"I just said it casually, and you actually took it seriously." Xu Qingzhu chuckled. "Am I that kind of bad person?"

"What if you're just being overprotective?" Liang Shi teased.

Xu Qingzhu propped her fingers against her temple. "Even that has limits. When it comes to matters of the heart, you can't stop it."

"Just like when I insisted on getting married back then. My parents didn't want me to, but... on one hand, I was pressured by the company, and on the other hand, it was because I wanted to do it. Even if they hadn't agreed back then, I would have done it anyway." Xu Qingzhu softened her voice. "If the main road doesn't work, you can always take a secret path. Young girls in love usually don't think straight."

Liang Shi: "?"

"Who are you talking about?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu looked straight at her, her voice light and airy. "Me."

Liang Shi: "..."

"Oh." Liang Shi was amused by her. "So were you love-brained before, or are you love-brained now?"

Xu Qingzhu thought for two seconds. "Before, I was love-brained. Now, I'm..."

She paused for a long time, then said slowly and deliberately, word by word: "Fallen—in—love."

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1. Sister-complex (妹控): A term borrowed from Japanese (siscon/シスコン), referring to someone who is extremely protective and doting toward their younger sister or sister-like figures. ⇐